

# Words ending in -e or -y

WORDS ENDING IN -E OR -Y OFTEN CHANGE THEIR SPELLINGS WHEN A SUFFIX IS ADDED.

The final -e in words is usually silent. If a suffix is added, the -e is sometimes dropped. A final -y sometimes changes to an *i* when a suffix is added.

## SEE ALSO

◀ 130-131 Vowel sounds

◀ 132-133 Consonant sounds

◀ 140-141 Roots

◀ 142-143 Prefixes and suffixes

Silent letters

160-161 ▶

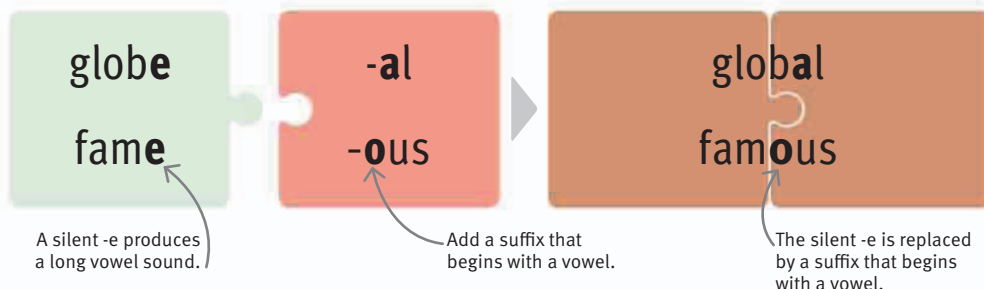
| Root word | Suffix | New word |
|-----------|--------|----------|
| argue     | -ment  | argument |
| awe       | -ful   | awful    |
| due       | -ly    | duly     |
| nine      | -th    | ninth    |
| true      | -ly    | truly    |
| whole     | -ly    | wholly   |
| wise      | -dom   | wisdom   |

## △ Exceptions

There are many exceptions to the rules, some of which are listed in this table.

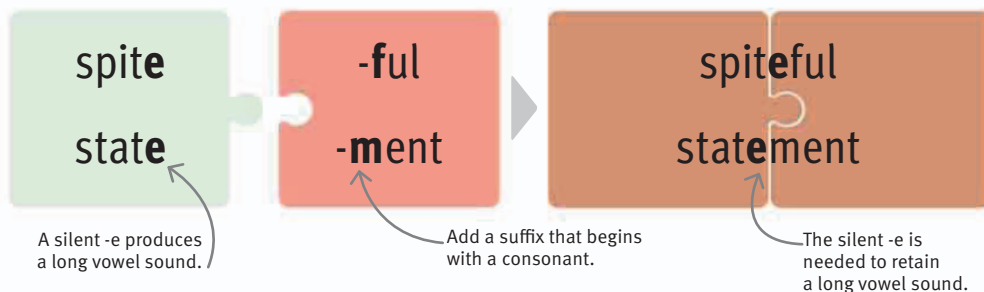
### ▷ Rule 1

If a word ends in a silent -e, the silent -e is dropped when a suffix beginning with a vowel is added.



### ▷ Rule 2

If a word ends in a silent -e, the silent -e is kept when a suffix beginning with a consonant is added.



### ▷ Rule 3

If a word ends in -ce or -ge, the silent -e must be retained with the suffixes -able and -ous.

